Suddaby School Council

November 20, 2023

Present: Barb Tompkins, Katherine Akins, Katha Broschek, Joel Leslie, Karin Korth, Lisa Farlow, Neil Callaghan, Mel McShane, Simon McNaughton, Tiffany Moore
Regrets: Sarah Taylor, Jill Kraft, Sue Campbell, Simon McNaughton, Kunal Mistry, Neamn Yohannes

Administrators' Report:

- ***Land Acknowledgement:*** Thanks to Mrs. Clarke's Grade 2 Class

- ***Treaties Recognition Week: Week of Nov. 6-10***
    - Students were challenged to create a slide deck to be chosen for the announcements that shared what a 2 Wampam Belt is and what it means:
    - Winners: Shared their learning on Nov. 10 on the announcements
        - Mrs. Clarke's Class-2 students read about their learning on the announcements
        - Rory T and Leo E from P1-3/4FI
        - Noah P from 4BFI

- ***Movember Challenge:***
    - Mr. Stuart and other staff members have kicked off MO-vember. This is a month for growing mustaches and raising awareness for mental health and cancer research. Starting today, until the end of MO-vember, we will be raising money and bringing attention to mental health issues and cancer research. There are two ways you can help: get 'caught in the act' of performing a random act of kindness for someone else or donating $1 (or more!). Each of the ways will earn you a ballot for a draw at the MO-vember assembly, where you could be picked to throw a pie in the face of a staff member of your choice!
    - We will be looking for students who are going above and beyond in showing kindness…not just simply holding the door for others, although that is kind, but also just polite. We will be looking for students who go out of their way to be kind…such as making sure someone is ok when they are hurt. Advocating for someone who was treated in an unkind way. Including someone in an activity that is not normally someone you would hang out with. Checking in with students who are quieter to see how their day is going…what can you do to go out of your way to be kind?

- ***First Pizza Day was on Friday, Nov. 17***
    - This year we are working with an outside company called ESNS so orders have to be done through a link to their company which can be found on School Day
    - 2.50 per slice, however parents who need support can order and bypass the payment. Those who exercise this option need to fill in a google; this information is also provided on School Day

- Parents can also donate to buy extra slices for other students. Donations go through the ESNS website, options are $2, $5 and $10
- Proceeds of pizza day will go to providing supplies for our sensory room, calming room and classroom calming rooms (eg. bicycle desks, small trampolines, sensory equipment, mats, etc.)
- Parents must order 2 weeks in advance for their child to receive their pizza.
- Thank you to Mel McShane, Tiffany Moore and Katha Broschek for their efforts!

- ***Remembrance Day Assembly***
  - On Nov. 10, we had a lovely whole school assembly to acknowledge Remembrance day
  - Thank you to Mrs. Snyder who planned and organized as well as all the classes who helped to decorate the gym prior to the assembly, Ms. Shantz who lead students in singing Peace Like a River, and Ms. Cober-Anderson whose class shared the word “peace” in different languages.

- ***Clubs:***
  - Skipping club is on Day 1 for Grades 3 and 6
  - Volleyball for grades 5 and 6 is on Day 5

- ***Bullying Prevention Week is this week:***
  - Our focus this week will be on mental health strategies to take of ourselves and others
  - Being mindful of our words and actions and how they affect others
  - Older grades will continue to discuss the effects of social media with regards to wellness and safety

- ***Coming up:***
  - *World Children’s Day-Thursday-Wear Blue*
  - *Nov. 30-Vision Screening for SK*
  - *Nov. 30 and Dec. 11-Humane Society Visits*
  - *Dec. 22-last day of school before winter break*
  - *Dec. 25-Jan. 5-No School*
  - *First day back to school-Jan. 8*

Teachers’ Report:

- Reminder that parents wishing to accompany field trips must have a valid WRPS Vulnerable Sector check. The cost for this is $20 if it is to be used to volunteer (as opposed to paid employment). Suddaby Administration will provide a letter in support of this. Parents unable to cover the $20 cost can contact the school to arrange for payment to be made on their behalf. **If you wish to volunteer, it is recommended that you arrange for your WRPS check in advance as the time to complete them varies.**

- The SpecEd equipment requested by Ms Lynch at the last Council meeting has been purchased

Communications Report:

- "Week at a Glance"on Schoolday will now have a "From Parent Council" section
- A monthly newsletter is now underway
- Goal of getting more parents on our facebook page: https://www.facebook.com/groups/802267584151563

Financial Report:

School funds: $24481.29
Wefi: $8570.23
Total: $33051.52

- NOTE: the WRDSB now takes 2.9% of all cash donations as a handling fee. This applies retroactively to all donations received since September.

Fundraising Report:

- Family Sharing night has been postponed to December 6th to allow more time to collect donations
- December 13th, popcorn will be sold at nutrition break for $2
- Future fundraising days include:
    - Popcorn day (January17)
    - Family Trivia Night (February 7)
    - Seed Sales (March,date TBD)
    - Dance-a-thon (April 17)
    - Sports/Arts night (May 15)
    - Fun Fair (June 19)
    - Domino's Pizza "care" nights (dates TBD)
- Fundraising team has applied for a grant for the playground and is gathering materials to put together a flyer to distribute to local businesses in hopes of corporate donations towards the playground. If you have experience with corporate donors or if your company or place of employment might want to contribute to this project, please email lisafarlow@gmail.com!

Strong Start:

- Strongstart is an early literacy support program run by volunteers in the school. Volunteers will be paired with children for 10 30-minute (typically weekly) sessions. Training is provided (and mandatory), both online and in person, free of charge.

- Volunteers are badly needed; if you would like to help please contact Katherine Akins at kakins@rogers.com
- Strong Start Link for training: https://strongstart.ca/programs/letters-sounds-and-words/training/

- The WRDSB now requires all volunteers to complete the volunteer interview form and reference check below, and to provide a Vulnerable Sector Check by the WRPS. There is a fee for the WRPS check of $20 if you indicate that it is required for a volunteer position. If you wish to volunteer and require assistance covering the WRPS fee, please contact Suddaby administration.
- Volunteer Interview Form https://staff.wrdsb.ca/policyprocedure/files/2020/02/Appendix-A-Volunteer-Application.pdf
- Volunteer Reference Check form https://staff.wrdsb.ca/policyprocedure/files/2020/02/Appendix-B-Reference-Check.pdf
- WRPS Vulnerable Sector Check: https://www.wrps.on.ca/en/services-reporting/police-vulnerable-sector-check.aspx

Future Business:

- Our next meeting will be January 15, 2024. NO DECEMBER MEETING
- Happy holidays!